

Crossing – This is a white spotlight with medium intensity and wide focus and can be used to brighten up a product shoot. If the background is all white, then the light can be put to good use.

There are other light source features present as well, which is why designers should acquaint themselves with the overall domain.

Shadows

Using the Adobe suite of mobile products is helpful in this case. They come with software integrations that have shadows already present. These shadow tools can allow you to bring out the subject in the frame automatically.

There is a bit of editing involved to clean up the image, but the overall shadow can be applied holistically to the image. On the Adobe App, you can go over to “Make Adjustments” and click on the Shadow icon. From there you can slide around on the levels to have the perfect amount of shadow being portrayed.

You can also choose Auto Enhance, and the software will add a shadow naturally for you. You can then edit out the finer details and ensure that the shadow fits in well with the image. Ideally, if there are multiple subjects in the shot, then you should work on shadow development individually.

This means that you need to craft out the shadow based on the light source present and what emotion you want to invoke. You can start by working with the contours of the face or the buildings in the frame. You can then move on to macro-level shadow developing which comes later on after you're done.

Shadows are also useful to develop when there are multiple subjects in the frame. This helps establish the context in the image so that designers can bring out the art in the image. When there is a single subject, like a hero shot or a product shot, then it's important to use the right type of shadow.

The shadow also can be applied by duplicating the layer and using reflection-based principles. The shadow can be darkened out and established as per the position of the subject. The shadow may even come out much finer in the final edit, as there is more control over the depth and intricacy. You can then focus on the opacity of the shadow to tell a better story.

If it's an afternoon shot and you want to add more depth to the image, the shadows will come out stronger and harsher. This evokes a certain sense of emotion in the viewer of the image who can then feel that harshness and warmth of the image. This is important to note as different shadows can create different feelings in the final image.